

Seawall height in Gulf Stream

The elevation your city requires, the datum it is measured in, and the section of code that says so.

GULF STREAM • PALM BEACH COUNTY

No minimum set in local code

Gulf Stream sets no minimum seawall height. It caps new or replacement seawalls on Intracoastal-connected water at 8 ft NGVD (or the NAVD equivalent).

The detail

MINIMUM	None set
MAXIMUM	No greater than 8 ft NGVD or its equivalent in NAVD - Sec. 70-78
SEAWALL REQUIRED	Owners on tidal/brackish water must bulkhead their frontage (not ocean) - Sec. 52-26
PLANS	Town commission approval - Sec. 52-27
HISTORY	The cap was first set by Ord. No. 15/9 (12 Feb 2015) and amended by Ord. No. 22-9 (28 Oct 2022) - Sec. 70-78
TURBIDITY SCREENS	During clearing, excavating, jetting and backfilling the contractor must fully enclose the site with screens reaching the bottom, left in place 24 hours after work stops or until turbidity returns to normal - Sec. 52-28
DOCKS AND LIFTS	Boats dock parallel to the seawall only. Docks may be no higher than the abutting seawall or 5.5 ft above mean sea level, whichever is greater; lift equipment max 5 ft above the seawall, and no part of a lifted vessel more than 10 ft above it - Sec. 66-369(4), (6)

Where this comes from: Town of Gulf Stream Code, Ch. 70 Art. IV Sec. 70-78 Seawall height; Ch. 52 Art. II Seawalls, Bulkheads, Etc. (Ord. 22-9, 10-28-22); Sec. 52-28; Ch. 66 Sec. 66-369

Verified: 2026-10. Rules change — check the date above against today.

Before you call a contractor

1

Know your datum

A height means nothing without the datum it is measured from. NAVD88 and MLW are different reference points and the same wall gives different numbers in each. Ask which one any quoted elevation refers to.

2

Get the existing elevation surveyed

You cannot tell whether a wall meets the requirement by looking at it. A surveyor shooting the top of the cap settles it in an hour.

3

Ask what triggers the requirement

Most cities only apply the minimum to new walls or to substantial repair. What counts as substantial is defined differently in each city, and it is usually a percentage of length or of cost.

4

Ask about building higher now

Several cities require a wall built below the final figure to be engineered so it can be raised later. Doing it once is cheaper than doing it twice.